The Gate and the Log

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 2, Episode 7

Nib leaned against the fallen log. It did not move. He leaned more grandly. His goggles moved, but the log still did not. The Mill gate caught near its hinge. Lark crouched beside the bottom rail instead of pushing at the largest piece of wood.

“I was moving the large difficulty,” Nib explained breathlessly. “Let us try the small gap,” Lark urged gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **pen**

“Here g makes the sound at the beginning of gap,” Lark modeled clearly. “Use your voice for the brief /g/, without adding a vowel. Join g, a, p. Other words can give this letter another sound later; today we are using gap and get.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try gap, get, got, dig, tag. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read gap on the repair diagram,” Lark invited softly. “Which small opening does its arrow show beside the hinge?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

Pat got mad. Sam did not get mad.

“Which friend stayed calm in the little passage?” Lark asked gently. “Read the sentence with not.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Through the gap, Lark could see a loose branch wedged under the hinge. Nib threaded a short strap around that branch. Together they lifted only the loose piece. The heavy log remained stable on the ground. The gate swung free, and your two undelivered invitations entered the Mill yard without a single log being rolled away.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write gap beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark drew the small branch beside the large log. The open gate was the result of moving the right thing. Ahead, round containers crowded the Mill delivery ledge. Nib kept the envelope in his bag while they looked for a flat place.